

# Description

This dataset consists of all starter packs and all following network data available on Bluesky as of late October 2025. Starter packs can be created by any Bluesky user. They are lists of users and curated feeds with a minimum of 8 and a maximum of 150 entities, curated by the starter pack creator, and users typically name them and provide a description. Other users can use a single click to follow all entities in the starter pack, or they can scroll through a specific starter pack to decide which entities to follow within that starter pack. In our dataset, all DIDs (persistent, unique identifiers) are anonymized via a one-to-one mapping between DIDs and integers in the range  $[0, \text{num\_users})$ ; users in the network, as well as users who created starter packs, or appear in starter packs, are identified by a unique, anonymous integer that maps to a single DID. Similarly, starter packs themselves are identified by anonymous unique integer IDs in the range  $[0, \text{num\_starter\_packs})$ . All timestamps are truncated to the nearest date.

First, we include the Bluesky following network as it appeared in late October 2025 in two formats: a compressed CSV and a parquet file. This dataset shows all available directed following relationships on Bluesky, along with timestamps indicating the day on which the following event occurred. We also include a network dataset of starter packs with information on creators and starter pack members; this is intended for users who wish to undertake a computational analysis of the networks created by starter packs or starter packs' influences on networks. Additionally, we include the starter pack network in two file formats that facilitate analysis of the starter pack hypergraph for research on higher-order network interactions. Note that the following network requires 460 GB of RAM and 5.5 hours to **load** as an [igraph](#) object and 310 GB of RAM and 2.75 hours to **load** as a [graph-tool](#) object.

| Filename                    | Description                                                                                                           | Data Structure / Types                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| deidentified_nodes.jsonl.gz | gzipped JSON lines file (list) containing an anonymized list of nodes on Bluesky as of November 2025. Size: 221.4 MB. | List of JSON dicts, each with the following keys and values:<br><b>node-id</b> : integer; anonymized identifier for that node<br><b>date-created</b> : date in YYYY-mm-dd format; can be absent; the date on which the starter pack was created. Precision is at the day level.<br><b>active</b> : boolean; indicates whether the node was active (i.e. normal status) or not (deactivated or taken down) at the time of data collection.<br><b>status</b> : string; can be absent, but otherwise is one of |

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|                                      |                                                                                                                                                            | {‘deactivated’, ‘normal’, ‘takedown’}. ‘deactivated’ indicates the account’s removal was user-initiated; ‘takedown’ indicates that Bluesky took the account down.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| deidentified_nodes.csv.gz            | CSV containing an anonymized list of nodes on Bluesky as of November 2025. Size: 187.7 MB                                                                  | Has four comma-separated fields, of which <b>date-created</b> , <b>active</b> , and <b>status</b> can be empty:<br><b>id</b> : integer; anonymized identifier for that node<br><b>date-created</b> : date in YYYY-mm-dd format; can be absent; the date on which the starter pack was created. Precision is at the day level.<br><b>active</b> : boolean; indicates whether the node was active (i.e. normal status) or not (deactivated or taken down) at the time of data collection. Can be absent.<br><b>status</b> : string; can be absent, but otherwise is one of {‘deactivated’, ‘normal’, ‘takedown’}. ‘deactivated’ indicates the account’s removal was user-initiated; ‘takedown’ indicates that Bluesky took the account down.                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| deidentified_starterpack_hif.json.gz | gzipped HIF-compliant JSON file. For details on the HIF standard, see the associated <a href="#">repository</a> and <a href="#">paper</a> . Size: 111.5 MB | In the output, <b>nodes</b> are anonymized integer identifiers for each user and <b>edges</b> are starter packs. <b>Nodes</b> have a unique integer identifier ( <b>‘node’</b> ), an optional boolean ‘active’ attribute, and an optional string <b>‘status’</b> attribute that, if present, will be one of {‘deactivated’, ‘normal’, or ‘takedown’}. <b>Edges</b> have a unique integer identifier ( <b>‘id’</b> ), a <b>‘creator-id’</b> attribute that corresponds to the anonymized integer id node that created that edge, and a <b>‘date-created’</b> attribute (string) in YYYY-mm-dd format that indicates the date on which the starter pack (edge) was created. Each entry in <b>incidences</b> contains an integer edge ID ( <b>‘edge’</b> ), an integer node ID ( <b>‘node’</b> ) that belongs to one node in the edge, and a <b>‘date-added’</b> attribute in YYYY-mm-dd format that indicates when the node was added to that edge. |

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| deidentified_starterpack_edgelist.csv.gz | A hyperedge list stored as a gzipped CSV file. Each line in file corresponds to a starter pack and each entry in the line is a member of the starter pack. Size: 46.6 MB | Each line contains entries separated by commas and corresponds to a starter pack. E.g., “1,2,3,4” indicates that users with anonymized identifiers 1, 2, 3, and 4 belong to the same starter pack. Note that this does not contain any timestamps.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| deidentified_starterpacks.jsonl.gz       | gzipped JSON lines file (list) containing an anonymized list of starter packs on Bluesky as of November 2025. Size: 86.1 MB                                              | Each line contains the following keys:<br><b>pack-id</b> : integer that corresponds to <b>edge ids</b> in the HIF-compliant JSON file and line numbers in the gzipped CSV.<br><b>date-created</b> : string; YYYY-mm-dd date on which the pack was created.<br><b>creator-id</b> : integer; anonymized node identifier for the pack’s creator.<br><b>members</b> : list of dicts with keys ‘ <b>id</b> ’ (integer corresponding to a starter pack member) and ‘ <b>date-added</b> ’ (YYYY-mm-dd date string indicating when the member was added to the starter pack). |
| deidentified_follows_edgelist.csv.gz     | Compressed CSV that delineates who follows whom on Bluesky. Includes following timestamps rounded to the nearest day. Size: 14.9 GB.                                     | An entry of <b>from</b> , <b>to</b> , <b>date_followed</b> indicates that user <b>from</b> (identified with an anonymized integer ID) followed user <b>to</b> (also identified with an anonymized integer ID) on the day <b>date_followed</b> (in YYYY-mm-dd format).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| deidentified_follows_edgelist.parquet    | Parquet compressed dataframe. Size: 12.6 GB.                                                                                                                             | Has the following columns:<br><b>from</b> : the integer ID of the user doing the following<br><b>to</b> : the integer ID of the user being followed<br><b>date_followed</b> : the date (YYYY-mm-dd format) on which the following event occurred                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

## Changelog 2025-12-11

1. Added information for **deidentified\_nodes.csv.gz**. Ensured that data collection dates were correct.

## Changelog 2025-12-09

1. Added file sizes to each entry in the table & added RAM/time requirements to load the following graph per Tommaso Bertola's suggestions.

## Changelog 2025-11-12

1. Added **correct** timestamps (following event timestamps rounded to the nearest date) to the following network files and updated the following network through November 2025: **deidentified\_follows\_edgelist.csv.gz** and **deidentified\_follows\_edgelist.parquet**, both of which succeed their counterparts with the same names. Many thanks to [Tommaso Bertola](#) at the University of Padua for pointing out issues with the timestamps in the prior version of the dataset.
2. Removed **deidentified\_follows\_graph.gt.gz** because it no longer fits into 256 GB of memory and is therefore not practically useful for most researchers.
3. Added a nodelist, **deidentified\_nodes.jsonl.gz**, that contains anonymized information about nodes only, including their active status and deactivation type. This is current as of November 10, 2025.
4. **deidentified\_starterpacks.jsonl.gz** succeeds **deidentified\_starterpack\_blob.json.gz** with a slightly different format (JSON lines file vs. JSON blob). Data is current as of November 10, 2025 and adds information on when each starter pack member account was **added** to the starter pack.
5. **deidentified\_follows\_edgelist.csv.gz** succeeds the file with the same name. The data is now up to date as of November 10, 2025.
6. **deidentified\_starterpack\_hif.json.gz** succeeds the file with the same name. The data is now up to date as of November 10, 2025. The file incorporates information about when each node was added to each starter pack in the **date-added** attribute. Nodes come with information about their active status (**active** attribute) and the reason for their inactivity (**status** attribute).
7. The codebook was updated to reflect the changed data files.

## Changelog 2025-08-12

1. Added timestamps (following event timestamps rounded to the nearest date) to following networks;  
**deidentified\_follows\_edgelist.zip** is replaced/succeeded by **deidentified\_follows\_edgelist.csv.zip**, **deidentified\_follows\_graph.gt.gz**, and **deidentified\_follows\_edgelist.parquet**, all of which provide the same following network, now with timestamps. The additional formats are meant to make the dataset more usable to a wide variety of practitioners.
2. The starter pack data now includes account creation dates for the users in the starter packs and the **creator-date-created** field was removed since starter pack creators always belong to the starter pack; all other data remains the same. The following files are replaced:
  - a. **deidentified\_starterpack\_hif.json** is replaced by **deidentified\_starterpack\_hif.json.gz**.
  - b. **deidentified\_starterpack\_edgelist.csv** is replaced by **deidentified\_starterpack\_edgelist.csv.gz**.
  - c. **deidentified\_starterpack\_blob.json** is replaced by **deidentified\_starterpack\_blob.json.gz**.
3. This codebook has been updated to reflect the updated data files.